'Hey! Wait a minute,' Pongo shouted.

He caught me by the collar, took me into his cabin nearby and looked into my pockets. There were seventeen oranges. Pongo counted them and placed them carefully on the table.

'Too many people are stealing from the docks,' Pongo said, 'You've stolen these oranges and concealed them in your pocket. Have you anything to say?'

- Did the narrator believe Clem's story?
- What was the narrator carrying in his pockets?
- Who is Pongo?

I said nothing. I was very frightened, but I kept quiet. I had read a lot of detective stories to make the mistake of blabbing. Anything you say may be used as evidence against you. I knew that the best plan was to say nothing.

'So you won't say anything,' said Pongo. 'I'm going to bring another policeman here. He'll be a witness against you, when I bring up this case in the court.'

Pongo left the cabin and locked the door behind him. I was very worried.

I looked at the walls. I looked at the door. I looked at the seventeen oranges, and I looked at the apron with its broken string.

I'll lose my job, I thought. Perhaps I'll go to prison. What will my father say? What will my father do?

I almost gave up the hope of escaping from the trouble. I was locked in the cabin and the oranges were on the table. Pongo had gone to bring a witness. I was in trouble.

'Oh, my God!' I said.

'What can I do?'

'Eat the oranges', said a voice in my head. *'Eat the evidence.'*

'Eat them?' I asked.

'Yes,' said the voice in my head. *'Eat them and the evidence will be gone. Be quick! Eat them all.'*

- Why did Pongo want to bring another policeman?
- What did the voice in the narrator's head tell him to do?

I thought for half a second. Then I took an orange. I peeled it and put it in my mouth. Soon, only the pips were left.

DO YOU KNOW?



- One orange contains our daily requirement of vitamin C.
- Oranges were first grown in India and then they spread to the other parts of the world.

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